Figure 1

Mars - A New Home For Mankind

For thousands of years people worshiped planets like gods. Mars is one of them. And our fascination with it only increased over the years. We are now at a point where it seems travelling to other celestial objects is possible.

The Earth is becoming uninhabitable which means we have to adapt or go away. Mars is one possibility. We already have drones and rovers up there. It's just a matter of time. And time is the key! We don't know how much time we have left on the blue planet. We have to be faster. Luckily there are a few people who dedicate themselves to the dream of colonizing Mars. One of them is Elon Musk. He revolutionized space travel by making rockets reusable and therefor decreasing the price of sending rockets into space. He wants to send a fleet of thousand Falcon Heavies, the world's strongest rocket ever build by human, to Mars. In my opinion this is impractical because rockets running on fossil fuels require excessive amounts of propellants, and the journey would take months. Furthermore we could only send rockets to Mars every two years to utilize the optimal transfer orbit. A much better way would be space ships using nuclear propulsion. Their journey would only take weeks.

But is a colony on Mars really the best thing we could do? It is, in fact, a smart and healthy way to get humanity living among the stars: There is around the same gravity as on earth which we need for muscles and proper brain function and there is a little magnetic field that protects humans from solar radiation. Otherwise we could build large rotating space stations to generate artificial gravity via centrifugal force but they too have to be built at first and need some kind of energy source.

At the end, we do need other homes than earth in order to guarantee the survival of our species. However when it will be and how it will look like lies for now behind the craziest imaginations...

Sources

Figure 1: Picture of Mars	https://www.google.com/imgres?q=mars_home&imgurl=https%3A%2F%2Fupload.wikimedia.org%2Fwikipedia%2Fcommons%2Fe%2Fef%2FPIA23302-FirstHumansOnMars-ArtistConcept.jpg%3Futm_source%3Den.wikipedia.org%26utm_campaign%3Dindex%26utm_content%3Doriginal&imgrefurl=https%3A%2F%2Fen.wikipedia.org%2Fwiki%2FMars_habitat&docid=eLL6Te778tef0M&tbnid=U7ZPpS5mRw10eM&vet=12ahUKEwjkrb6K5_KWAxUmQPEDHWsMAbUQnPAOegUIqQEQAA..i&w=10224&h=5144&hcb=2&ved=2ahUKEwjkrb6K5_KWAxUmQPEDHWsMAbUQnPAOegUIqQEQAA